

RetailzPOS AEO Execution Guide

October 15, 2026 – April 15, 2027 · Amrin, Kajol, Navaid · Target: AI citation rate from ~10% to 40%+

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0. How this guide fits with everything already built

This is the execution layer, not new strategy — it assigns real people and real dates to work already designed across six existing documents in this repo:

Document	What it contributes to this guide
retailzpos-ai-visibility-audit-2026-07.md	The original per-engine scoring methodology and the 3 specific failed queries — the basis for Section 1’s measurement panel
retailzpos-aeo-geo-improvement-strategy-2026-07.md	The tiered fix plan and engine-specific tactics this timeline schedules
retailzpos-aeo-geo-reddit-quora-strategy-2026-07.md	The exact subreddits, the 12 live Quora question URLs, and the disclosure rules used in Section 7
retailzpos-technical-seo-geo-crawl-analysis-2026-07.md	The schema/technical fixes scheduled in Section 9
retailzpos-ai-search-visibility-playbook-2026-08.md	The YouTube workstream, entity/Wikidata workstream, and topic bank this guide schedules into specific weeks
retailzpos-benchmark-report-groundwork-2026-07.md	The flagship data report scheduled for Month 3

Nothing below invents a new tactic that isn’t already justified somewhere in that prior research. This guide’s only job is: who does it, on which day, by when.

1. The goal, defined precisely

“10% to 40%+ AI citation visibility” only means something if it’s measured the same way every time. Here’s the method this guide commits to:

The test panel: 24 real, buyer-phrased queries — 6 per vertical (liquor, convenience, smoke/vape, CBD), covering best-for, comparison, and compliance question types, extending the original 5 queries from the July audit.

The four engines tested: ChatGPT (search-grounded), Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot, Google AI Overviews/Gemini — the same four from the July audit.

The number: citation rate = (queries × engines where RetailzPOS is named or cited) ÷ (24 queries × 4 engines = 96 total checks), run as actual live queries, not estimated.

Baseline: re-run the full 96-check panel in Week 1 (Oct 15–16) before any new work ships, to confirm the real starting number — treat “10%” as the working assumption until that baseline run confirms it.

Re-measurement cadence: full 96-check panel at the end of Month 1, Month 3 (benchmark report launch), and Month 6 (final). Lighter 5-query spot-checks (the original July audit queries) at the end of every other month in between.

2. Team & roles

A proposed division of labor — adjust freely if these aren’t the right lanes for how the three of you actually work:

Person	Primary lane	What that means week to week
Navaid	Strategy, outreach, relationships	Guest-post pitching, review-site relationship management, trade press, monthly measurement review, final publish sign-off on anything compliance-sensitive
Amrin	Content production	Blog posts, FAQ/schema content, YouTube scripting and production coordination, benchmark report writing
Kajol	Community & review engagement	Reddit and Quora sessions (the recurring days in Section 3), review-site solicitation follow-through, social amplification of what Amrin publishes

3. The weekly rhythm — the recurring “day to day” structure

This repeats every week from October 15, 2026 through April 15, 2027. The month-by-month plan in Section 4 tells you what fills each slot; this section is the when, fixed for the whole six months.

Day	Owner	What happens
Monday	Amrin	Publish or finalize that week’s content piece (blog post, FAQ page, or YouTube video per Section 4’s schedule)

Day	Owner	What happens
Tuesday	Kajol — Reddit session, 1-1.5 hrs, fixed slot	Run the saved searches from Section 7.3 directly on reddit.com, answer 2–3 genuine threads with disclosure, check r/smallbusiness, r/Entrepreneur, r/AskBusiness first
Wednesday	Navaid	Outreach day — guest-post pitch follow-ups, review-site relationship check-ins, trade press contact; 15-min schema/technical sync with Amrin if anything shipped Monday needs a markup check
Thursday	Kajol — Quora session, 1 hr, fixed slot	Check the 12 tracked Quora questions (Section 7.4) plus a fresh search for new ones; answer 2–3 with disclosure
Friday	All three, 30 min	Weekly sync: what published, what was answered, any spot-check movement on the test queries, what’s next week

4. Month-by-month plan

Month 1 — Oct 15 to Nov 14: Foundation and baseline

Theme: get the measurement baseline locked, close the easy technical gaps, start the recurring cadence.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
1 (Oct 15–21)	Run the baseline 96-check test panel (Section 1) before anything else ships. Claim/verify Wikidata entity if not already live.	Navaid

Week	Deliverable	Owner
1	Send the internal and external review-request emails (drafted earlier this session — regenerate as a standalone file if not already saved) to start building G2/Capterra/Trustpilot/Birdeye volume	Navaid (internal), Kajol (follow-through)
1-2	Implement FAQPage schema and the 134-167 word direct-answer-block rewrite on the three audit-failed pages (liquor best-for, smoke/vape best-for, compliance page)	Amrin
2	Reddit/Quora cadence begins for real (Tuesday/Thursday, per Section 3) — start with the 12 live Quora questions in Section 7.4, prioritizing liquor and smoke/vape first	Kajol
3	Publish Blog #1: “RetailzPOS vs. Scotch POS” comparison page — net-new, built on the existing Scotch POS competitive deep dive already in this repo	Amrin
4	Publish Blog #2: “RetailzPOS vs. Santé POS” comparison page — same logic, built on the existing Santé deep dive	Amrin
4	Confirm G2 and TrustRadius profile status (claim if missing)	Navaid
End of month	Re-run the full 96-check panel; this is the first real comparison point against the baseline	Navaid

Month 2 — Nov 15 to Dec 14: Scale content, start YouTube

Theme: stand up the fourth citation surface (YouTube) and keep the comparison library growing.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
5	Publish Blog #3: “Best POS for CBD Retailers 2026” (the uncontested-category page from the Playbook topic bank)	Amrin
5	Stand up the YouTube channel; publish Video #1 — the full product tour, long-form, chaptered	Amrin
6	Publish Blog #4: “RetailzPOS vs. KORONA POS” comparison page (the gap identified in the July competitive teardown)	Amrin
6	Publish Video #2 — “Hard-Block vs. Soft-Block Age Verification, Explained”	Amrin
7	Guest-post pitch sent to Retail Dive’s Submit an Opinion program, with page-specific anchor links to the new comparison pages	Navaid
7–8	Thanksgiving/Black Friday content from the existing holiday content plan ships on schedule (already dated Oct 29 publish-by)	Amrin
Ongoing	Reddit/Quora cadence continues; start tracking the new keyword targets in Section 7.3	Kajol
End of month	Light 5-query spot-check	Navaid

Month 3 — Dec 15 to Jan 14: The benchmark report

Theme: ship the flagship data asset — the single highest-leverage citation play in the whole plan.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
9	Confirm data access/sample size for the benchmark report (per the groundwork doc’s open question)	Navaid

Week	Deliverable	Owner
9-10	Draft and publish The State of Independent Retail POS 2026 (full version or “early look,” per the groundwork doc’s fallback)	Amrin
10	Pitch Retail Dive / CSP Daily News / Convenience Store News for exclusive first-look coverage	Navaid
10-11	December holiday hub page and Hanukkah/Christmas content ships per the existing holiday content plan	Amrin
11	Publish Video #3 — “We Asked Our Own Data” (benchmark report companion video)	Amrin
12	New Year’s Eve content ships per the holiday plan	Amrin
Ongoing	Reddit/Quora cadence continues	Kajol
End of month	Full 96-check re-measurement — this is the real mid-point data point	Navaid

Month 4 — Jan 15 to Feb 14: Read the data, double down

Theme: this is the month to act on Month 3’s measurement rather than just keep producing evenly across every surface.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
13	Review the Month 3 full panel results as a team — identify which surface (editorial, YouTube, Reddit/Quora, LinkedIn) moved the needle most, per the “don’t spread effort evenly” principle from the Playbook	All three
13-14	Shift the next 4 weeks’ content mix toward whichever surface showed the clearest signal	Amrin (content), Kajol (community)

Week	Deliverable	Owner
14	Publish Video #4 — “Case-Break Inventory, How It Actually Works”	Amrin
15	Publish a new FAQ-bank page if gaps were found in the Month 3 review	Amrin
15-16	Second guest-post pitch, to Retail TouchPoints’ Executive ViewPoints, using the benchmark report as the news hook	Navaid
Ongoing	Reddit/Quora cadence continues	Kajol
End of month	Light 5-query spot-check	Navaid

Month 5 — Feb 15 to Mar 14: Authority consolidation

Theme: by now, guest posts should be live and reviews should have real volume — this month is about consolidating that authority, not starting new workstreams.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
17	Review-count check-in: how many G2/Capterra/Trustpilot/Birdeye reviews have come in since Month 1’s email push; second round of review requests to customers onboarded since	Kajol
17-18	Publish Videos #5-6 — two more comparison videos matching whichever written comparisons are getting cited	Amrin
18	Check whether any Wikipedia article (POS software, retail technology, liquor retail compliance) has picked up a citation yet; if not, identify a specific, factual, non-promotional edit opportunity	Navaid
19	Publish a new best-for or alternatives page for any vertical still thin in the comparison library	Amrin

Week	Deliverable	Owner
Ongoing	Reddit/Quora cadence continues	Kajol
End of month	Light 5-query spot-check	Navaid

Month 6 — Mar 15 to Apr 14: Final push and re-measurement

Theme: close out the full panel, document what worked, and set the next quarter's priorities from real data instead of a guess.

Week	Deliverable	Owner
21-22	Fill any remaining content gaps identified across the prior five months' measurements	Amrin
22	Third guest-post pitch or follow-up on outstanding ones	Navaid
23	Final push on review volume — target a specific number on each platform before the close-out measurement	Kajol
24	Full 96-check final re-measurement against the Section 1 baseline	Navaid
24	Team retrospective: what moved the number, what didn't, and a one-page next-quarter plan built from the answer	All three

5. Blog idea bank — consolidated and assigned

Pulling from the existing topic bank in the AI Search Visibility Playbook, plus net-new ideas this guide adds:

Already scheduled above (Months 1-2): - RetailzPOS vs. Scotch POS (new) - RetailzPOS vs. Santé POS (new) - Best POS for CBD Retailers 2026 - RetailzPOS vs. KORONA POS

In the existing topic bank, not yet dated — slot into Months 4–6 as gaps appear: - Best POS for Convenience Stores with Multiple Locations - RetailzPOS vs. a Generic/General-Merchandise POS (category-education page) - The full FAQ question bank (Section 6.2 of the Playbook) — convert the strongest 8–10 into their own short-form pages, not just schema snippets - State-by-state age-verification primer (compliance-authority extension) - What auditors actually ask for during a compliance review

Net-new, not in any prior document — worth considering if a gap opens up: - **“Why We Don’t Lock You Into Our Payment Processor”** — directly exploits the processor-lock-in weakness confirmed in both the Scotch and Santé competitive research. **Confirm RetailzPOS actually offers processor choice before writing this** — do not publish a capability claim ahead of the product. - **“Three Years Old vs. a Decade of Uptime: What ‘New’ Really Costs You in POS Software”** — a thought-leadership angle built on the confirmed finding that both Scotch and Santé are young companies with documented “edge cases still being discovered.”

6. Review-site campaign

Ties directly to the two email drafts already written this session (internal, to staff; external, to the current client list) covering Capterra, GetApp, Software Advice, SourceForge, Slashdot, Trustpilot, Birdeye, and Google. If those were never saved as a standalone file, say so and this guide can regenerate them as a companion document before Month 1, Week 1.

Platform	Status	Action this guide schedules
Capterra, GetApp, SoftwareAdvice, SourceForge, Slashdot, Trustpilot, Birdeye	Confirmed live profiles	Send the review-request emails Week 1; Kajol follows up monthly
Google	Needs the Business Profile review link pulled from the dashboard	Navaid, Week 1
G2	Not confirmed to exist	Navaid confirms/claims, Week 4
TrustRadius	Not confirmed to exist	Navaid confirms/claims, Week 4

7. Reddit and Quora — the exact cadence, not a generic placeholder

7.1 The fixed days (repeats every week, per Section 3)

Tuesday = Reddit. Thursday = Quora. Same two days, every week, for the full six months.

7.2 Subreddits, in priority order

1. r/smallbusiness — highest priority, most POS questions
2. r/Entrepreneur — high priority
3. r/AskBusiness — high priority, strong Q&A format fit
4. r/Bootstrapped — medium, good for cost/ROI-framed answers
5. r/SweatyStartup — monitor opportunistically, don't prioritize
6. **Do not post in r/retailhell or r/TalesFromRetail** — confirmed wrong audience (frontline workers venting, not owners evaluating software)

7.3 Reddit search strings to run every Tuesday

- POS system liquor store
- point of sale recommendation convenience store
- best POS smoke shop / best POS vape shop
- POS system age verification
- switching POS systems retail
- Square vs Clover vs Lightspeed liquor
- New targets from the August Playbook: case break inventory software, POS audit log compliance, multi-location convenience store POS recommendation, CBD store point of sale, SMS marketing vape shop compliance
- Set up F5Bot or a saved-search notification for these terms so Tuesday's session starts with a pre-filtered list, not a cold search

7.4 The 12 live Quora questions (answer in this order, liquor/vape first)

1. [What is the best POS software for liquor shop management?](#)
2. [What are the most popular/common POS Systems used by liquor store businesses?](#)
3. [Which is the best liquor store POS system?](#)
4. ["Best" POS system for a small, one station liquor store?](#)
5. [How can a liquor store POS system be customized to fit the specific needs of a particular store?](#)
6. [What is the best point of sale system for brick and mortar vape shops?](#)
7. [What cloud POS system is the best for a vape store and why?](#)
8. [What is the POS system for a small grocery store?](#)
9. [What are some good open source point of sale systems for convenience stores?](#)
10. [What's the most common POS software for gas stations?](#)
11. [What is the best POS software for retail businesses?](#)
12. [What are the most common POS systems for retailers?](#)

7.5 The non-negotiable rule for both platforms

Every answer discloses affiliation in the answer itself ("Full disclosure — I work at RetailzPOS, so factor that in, but here's an honest answer either way..."). Lead with genuine value before any product mention. Never post the same pitch across many threads in one sitting — pace it, per Tuesday/Thursday's fixed cadence, not a batch.

8. Technical and entity checklist (do these once, early, then they compound)

☐

Organization schema with sameAs links to every confirmed real profile (Capterra, GetApp, SourceForge, Slashdot, SoftwareAdvice, Trustpilot, Birdeye)

☐

FAQPage schema on every comparison and best-for page shipped in Months 1-2

☐

Wikidata entity created/verified

☐

Visible, accurate publish/last-updated dates on every page, actually kept current



Named, credentialed authorship on every guide and comparison post

9. Risks worth naming now

- **The 40%+ target is a goal to organize work around, not a guarantee** — AI citation behavior isn't fully controllable, consistent with how the July audit framed its own 90-day goal.
- **Reddit/Quora cadence is the easiest thing to let slip** when content production gets busy — it's scheduled on fixed days specifically so it doesn't quietly stop being Kajol's actual Tuesday/Thursday rather than an "ongoing" aspiration.
- **Don't publish the payment-processor blog idea (Section 5) without confirming the underlying capability first** — same discipline as everywhere else in this project.
- **The benchmark report (Month 3) is the single highest-risk, highest-reward item** — it depends on real data access being confirmed early; if sample size doesn't support a full report, ship the "early look" version rather than slipping the date.